

Weekly Self-Study Tasks to Complete

Phase 1 — Week 2: GitHub and GitHub Codebase Management for Leaders

This document covers all of Week 2 in the 4-hour Leaders model: 2 hours of instructor-led session, 1 hour of self-study video, and 1 hour of hands-on lab. The Core Resources table below fits inside the 1-hour self-study media budget. The Practice Activities section points to the Evergreen Insurance Quote Page — Pull Request lab, where you will push the project to GitHub and walk a real PR end-to-end. Additional Content at the end is optional and sits outside the 4-hour budget. Note: GitHub Actions is covered in depth in Week 7 (WA3857) — this week only names it in passing.

Core Resources (~60 min)

The week's single core video is deliberately concept-only: Aaron Stewart's "GitHub: The Big Picture" answers what GitHub is, how its major features fit together, and how to start using it, without asking you to run any commands. The lab is where you will actually push to GitHub and open a pull request. Every link and duration below has been verified against the source platform.

Topic	Material Description	Est. Time	Link / Reference
GitHub Concepts	GitHub: The Big Picture (Aaron Stewart, Pluralsight, updated Sep 24, 2022) — watch the full course. Five modules: introduction, What Is GitHub? (~14 min), How Can GitHub Help Me and My Team? (~18 min), Using GitHub to Collaborate, Develop, Secure, and Manage Software Projects (~19 min), and How to Get Started (~11 min). Concept-only — no coding exercises, no CLI drills. Leader-	~66 min	pluralsight.com — GitHub: The Big Picture

Topic	Material Description	Est. Time	Link / Reference
	appropriate tour of what GitHub is and how its features fit together.		
Slide Skim	Review the week's slide deck at a high level. Confirm you recognize the terms pull request, review, branch protection, CODEOWNERS, Dependabot, and squash-merge. No need to memorize details — this is a check that the instructor session and the Pluralsight course together left you fluent in the vocabulary you'll see on any GitHub PR page. Skim only.	~5 min	See course material

Practice Activities (1 hour)

Complete this week's hands-on lab: "Evergreen Insurance Quote Page — Pull Request." The starter is the same Evergreen project you have been building up in Weeks 2–5. This week you push it to a fresh GitHub repository of your own, create a short-lived feature branch, make one small edit, open a pull request with a real description, self-review the diff, approve the PR, squash-merge, and pull the merge back down to your local main. The whole workflow takes about one hour.

In the lab you will:

- Open the Labfiles/evergreen-quote-pull-request folder in VS Code and confirm it is a Git repository with an initial commit.
- Create a free GitHub account (if you do not already have one) and a new empty repository named `evergreen-quote-demo`.
- Wire the local repo to GitHub with `git remote add origin` and push `main`.
- Create a feature branch `update-hero-copy` and edit the `

` hero heading in `index.html` from "Coverage that grows with you" to "Coverage that scales with your life."
- Commit on the branch, push the branch, and open a pull request on github.com.

- Fill out a real PR description: Summary, Why, Test plan. Self-review the Files changed tab and leave one inline comment.
- Submit your own Approve via Review changes, then Squash and merge the PR and delete the branch.
- Back in the terminal, ``git checkout main && git pull`` and confirm the squash commit landed on your local main.
- Optional: repeat the cycle using the ``gh`` CLI — ``gh pr create --fill`` opens a PR directly from the terminal.

The lab instructions (with “Why this matters” callouts throughout) are in the lab environment. Budget one hour and work at your own pace.

Additional Content (Optional)

The following resources are optional and recommended for leaders who want to go deeper beyond the core curriculum. They sit outside the 4-hour weekly budget. None of these are required — you can absolutely stop at the Pluralsight course and the lab and have everything you need for the rest of Phase 1.

Topic	Material Description	Link / Reference
GitHub (Video)	Learning GitHub — Emanuele Bartolesi (LinkedIn Learning, Jan 17, 2023). 1h 4m Beginner. Covers Git fundamentals, command-line workflow, GitHub Desktop, the gh CLI, GitHub Pages, Actions deployments, and Codespaces. If the Pluralsight course leaves you wanting to see more of the platform's surface area (including hands-on CLI demos), this is the next step (Video Course)	linkedin.com/learning – Learning GitHub (2023)
GitHub Docs	GitHub Docs — Get Started. The official starting point on docs.github.com. Links to account setup, Git setup, the “Hello World” quickstart, writing and formatting on GitHub, and core collaboration articles. Better as a	docs.github.com – Get Started

Topic	Material Description	Link / Reference
	reference than cover-to-cover reading (Reference)	
Pull Requests	About pull requests — GitHub Docs. The canonical explanation of what a pull request is, how reviews and required approvals work, and the difference between draft and ready-for-review PRs. 10-15 minute read. Useful to bookmark for any time a PR conversation surfaces an unfamiliar term (Reference)	docs.github.com — About pull requests
Branch Protection	Managing a branch protection rule — GitHub Docs. The official walkthrough for creating, editing, and deleting protection rules on branches. Covers required reviews, required status checks, restrictions on who can push, and the “include administrators” toggle. Read this before you approve any proposed rule change on a repo you own (Reference)	docs.github.com — Branch protection rules
CODEOWNERS	About code owners — GitHub Docs. The reference for CODEOWNERS file syntax, placement, and interaction with branch protection. Leaders do not author CODEOWNERS files but do approve changes to them. This is the one page to read before any such approval (Reference)	docs.github.com — About code owners
Dependabot	Configuring Dependabot version updates — GitHub Docs. A walkthrough of the `dependabot.yml` file: update cadence, ecosystem targets (npm, pip, Maven), pull-request limits, auto-	docs.github.com — Configuring Dependabot

Topic	Material Description	Link / Reference
	merge patterns. Worth skimming so you can ask informed questions when a team proposes a cadence change (Reference)	
GitHub CLI	GitHub CLI Manual — cli.github.com. Official reference for the `gh` command-line tool you saw in this week's lab bonus section. Useful if you want to script repetitive PR or repo tasks, or if your engineers reference `gh` commands in chat (Reference)	cli.github.com — Manual
Free Book	Pro Git — Scott Chacon & Ben Straub (2nd edition, Apress). Free online under a Creative Commons license. Chapter 6 ("GitHub") is the Leader-relevant section: accounts, contributing to projects, maintaining projects, managing an organization, scripting GitHub. The rest of the book is Git internals and can be skipped (Book)	git-scm.com — Pro Git